

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 613

By Oliver

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend *The Tennessee Tribune* on the occasion of its thirty-fifth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should recognize those outstanding newspapers throughout the State of Tennessee that endeavor to provide exceptional news coverage and serve community needs and interests by means of poignant and thorough journalism; and

WHEREAS, *The Tennessee Tribune* celebrates its thirty-fifth anniversary this year, marking three and one-half decades of devoted service to Nashville's African-American community; and

WHEREAS, this important regional newspaper is the life's work and legacy of Rosetta Irvin Miller-Perry, who established the weekly missive in 1991 after retiring from a career with the United States government, having served with the United States Commission on Civil Rights and as Director of the United States Equal Employment Opportunity Commission under Clarence Thomas; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Miller-Perry, the daughter of Anderson and Mary Irvin, was born in Coraopolis, Pennsylvania, and graduated from Coraopolis Senior High School before serving in the United States Military; she was among the first African-American students to graduate from Memphis State University, now the University of Memphis, and went on to attend Howard University Law School; and

WHEREAS, in 1990, she founded Perry & Perry & Associates, Inc., and launched *Contempora Magazine*; the following year, she founded *The Tennessee Tribune*, a newspaper highlighting the African-American and minority community locally, regionally, and nationally, which became one of the approximately 200 African-American newspapers that were being published nationwide at the time; and

WHEREAS, denied funds from local banks, Rosetta Miller-Perry invested \$70,000 from her personal savings to launch *The Tennessee Tribune* and watched as it became one of the most influential African-American publications in the State; and

WHEREAS, within five years, Ms. Miller-Perry purchased her first building on Morena Street; however, her desire to be located in the heart of the African-American community led her to purchase and renovate a building on historic Jefferson Street—the historic Universal Insurance Building, which still houses the newspaper today; and

WHEREAS, under Ms. Miller-Perry's astute guidance, *The Tennessee Tribune* has become the most effective African-American weekly publication in Middle Tennessee, continuing to champion the cause of Civil Rights and the voices and leadership of African Americans; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to recognize and commend Ms. Miller-Perry and all who have contributed to *The Tennessee Tribune* for their unstinting dedication to providing Tennesseans with exceptional news coverage of an unparalleled caliber; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor founder Rosetta Irvin Miller-Perry and staff, past and present, of *The Tennessee Tribune* on the occasion of the newspaper's thirty-fifth anniversary, commending their meritorious service to the State of Tennessee in their unwavering pursuit of presenting exemplary news coverage.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.